Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

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Cap-Gap Extension

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What Is the Cap-Gap Extension?

For students transitioning to an H-1B visa, a gap may occur between the end of their F-1 status and the start of their H-1B status (typically Oct. 1). The Cap-Gap Extension automatically extends F-1 status and, if applicable, work authorization, to bridge this period. This extension remains in effect until the approved H-1B start date or April 1 of the following fiscal year, whichever comes first.

OIS advisors process Cap-Gap Extension I-20 Requests on behalf of students. To process the requests, students must provide proof that their petition has been properly filed.

What Is the H-1B Visa and H-1B Cap?

Who Is Eligible for a Cap-Gap Extension?

Need help?

Hi there! I'm Tommy, and I am here to answer your questions. What can I help with?

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What happens if I receive a pending or approved H-1B notice from USCIS after my current EAD has expired and I am in the 60-day grace period?

What happens if my H-1B petition is subsequently rejected, denied or revoked during the Cap-Gap Extension period?

Do OPT/STEM OPT unemployment rules apply to students with a Cap-Gap Extension?

Can I apply for STEM OPT Extension during the Cap-Gap Extension period?

Does the Cap-Gap Extension also extend my dependent's F-2 status?

May students travel outside the United States during a Cap-Gap Extension period and return in F-1 status?

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